

The Entrepreneur



Candice Thurston, a visionary entrepreneur, grew up facing numerous challenges that shaped her resilience and determination. Her formative years instilled a strong work ethic and a passion for excellence. Candice pursued higher education in business and marketing, laying a solid foundation for her future career.

Candice's corporate journey began at Unilever, where she managed brand growth and P&L for hair brands across Africa, the Middle East, and Turkey. She then transitioned to MTN, serving in senior marketing roles, including leading the MTN FIFA World Cup 2010 campaign. These roles honed her strategic thinking and leadership skills, preparing her for her entrepreneurial journey.

In 2014, Candice founded Candi & Co., a hair and beauty salon franchise with a mission to revolutionize the hair care industry for women of colour. Candi & Co. quickly became renowned for its understanding and excellent treatment of ethnic hair, de-racializing hair care, and providing personalized experiences. Candice's innovative approach, dedication to empowerment, and strategic acumen led to the successful growth of the franchise, culminating in its acquisition by the Sorbet Group in 2019. Following the acquisition, Candice remained with the organization until 2022, first as CEO of Candi & Co. and then as Group Marketing Executive for Sorbet. In August 2023, she transitioned to the banking sector, taking on the role of Managing Executive for Group Marketing and Brand at Absa Group.

Candice Thurston stands for innovation, empowerment, and excellence. Her journey reflects a commitment to breaking barriers and creating opportunities, especially for women of colour. Through her entrepreneurial endeavors and corporate leadership, Candice continues to inspire and drive positive change in the industries she touches.

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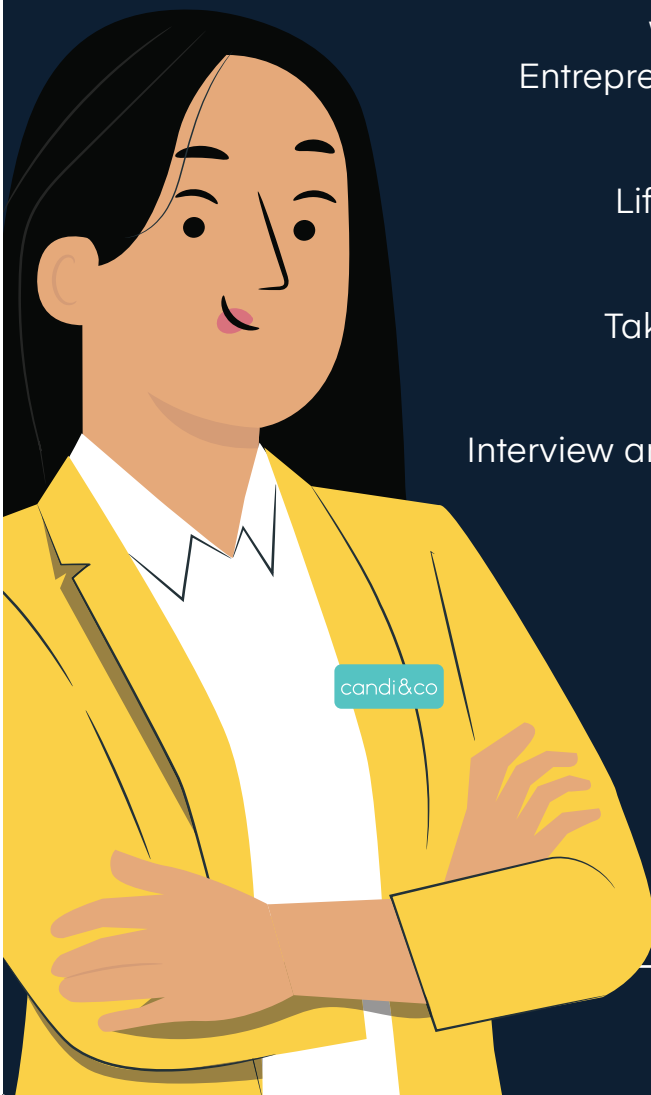
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Worksheet Zero:

The Entrepreneur's Journey

Worksheet 0

Summarise the entrepreneur's journey.



Upbringing, Education, and Career



Enterprising Efforts and Interests



Entrepreneurial Choices and Decisions



Pivotal Moment



Standout Idea



Opportunity Optimization



Current State



Balancing Life



The dilemma

Worksheet One:

Upbringing, Education & Career

Worksheet 1

Provide biographical information about the entrepreneur, including upbringing, education, career trajectory, and journey into entrepreneurship.

UPBRINGING...

EDUCATION...

CAREER...



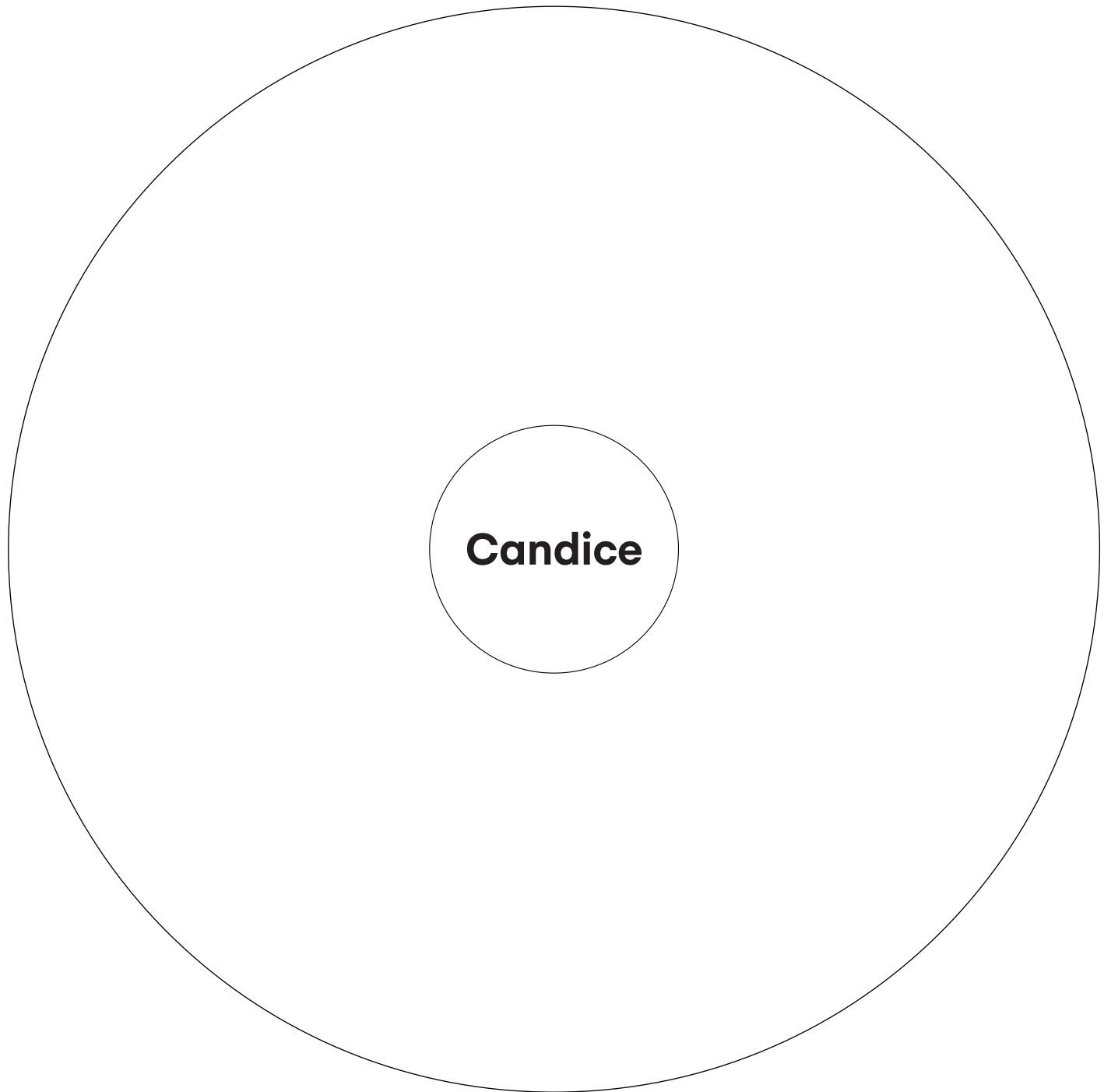


Worksheet Two:

Entrepreneurial Characteristics and Traits

Worksheet 2

Identify, analyse, and write in the circle the entrepreneurial characteristics and traits possessed by Candice.

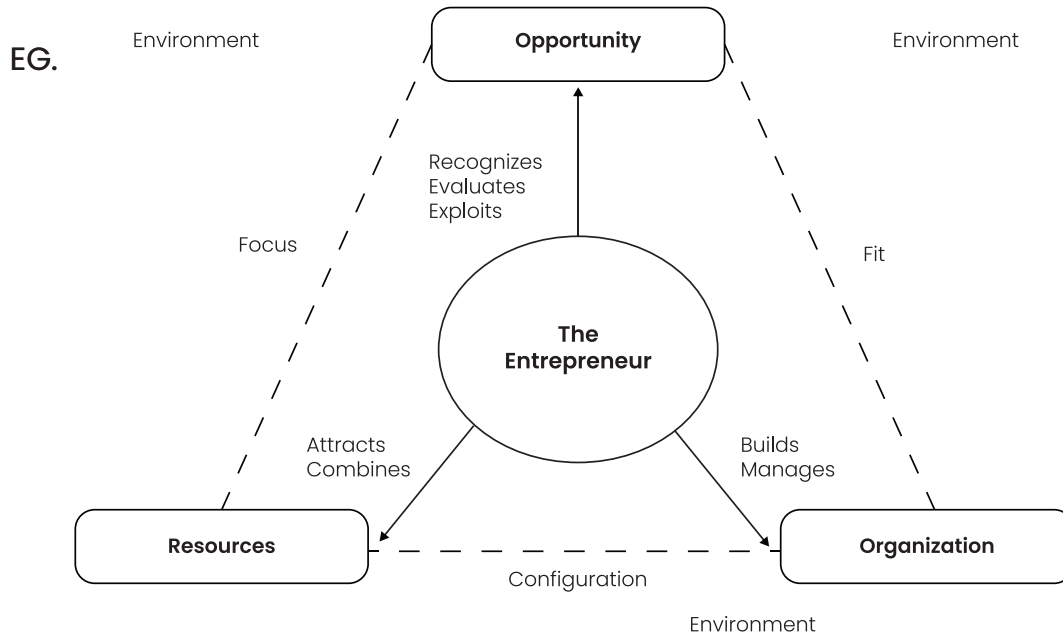


Worksheet Three:

The Entrepreneurship Process

Worksheet 3

Analyse how Candice recognised opportunities, leveraged resources, and formed an organisation and navigating the environment through the entrepreneurial process.



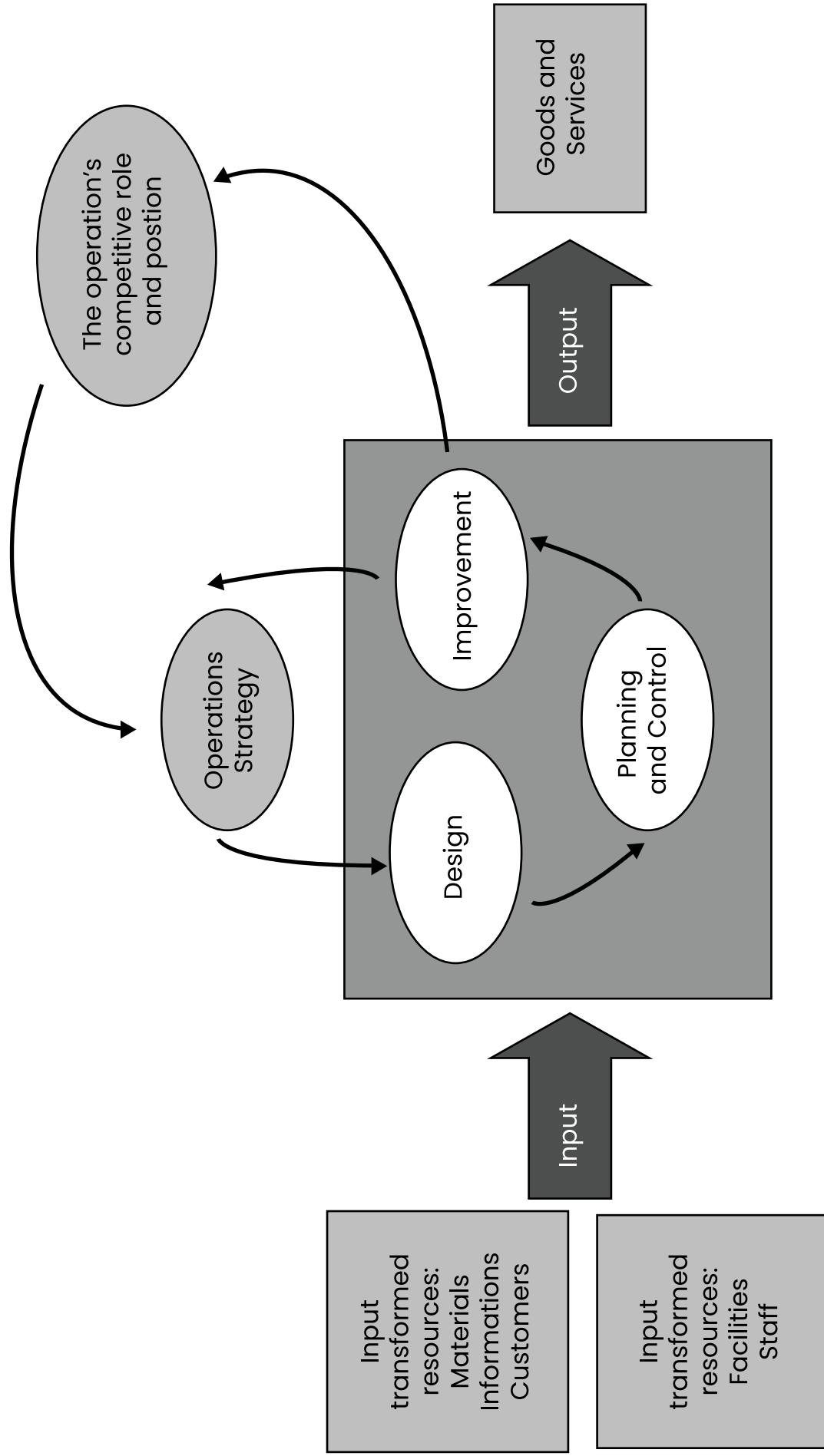
Worksheet Four:

Unpacking Candi & Co's Business Model

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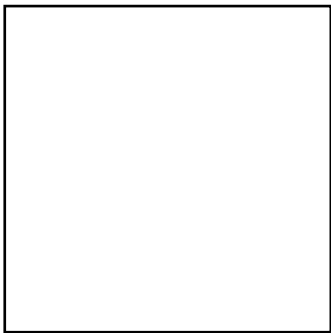
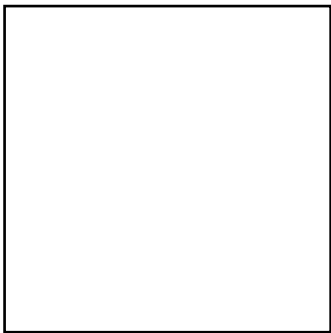
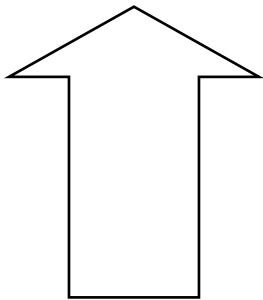
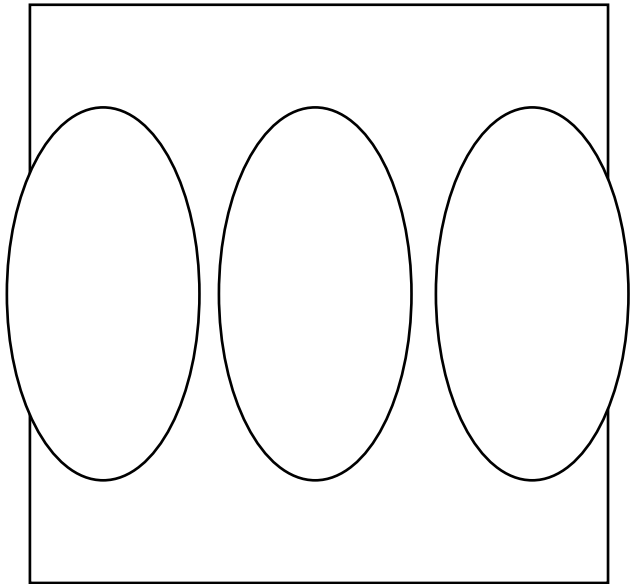
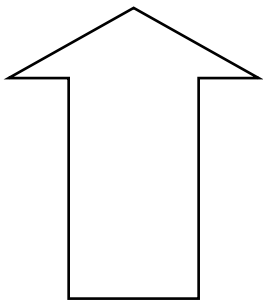
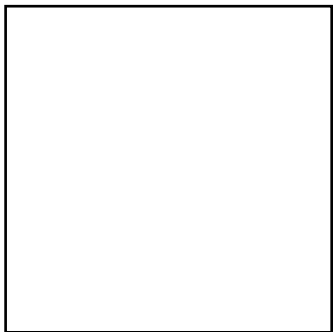
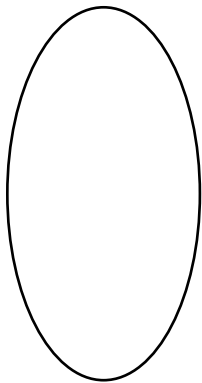
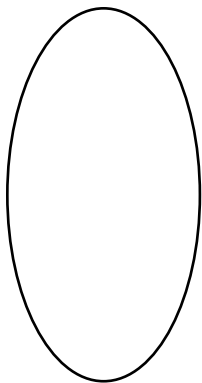


Worksheet 4.2 Operations Process



EG.

Worksheet 4.2 Complete the Operation Process

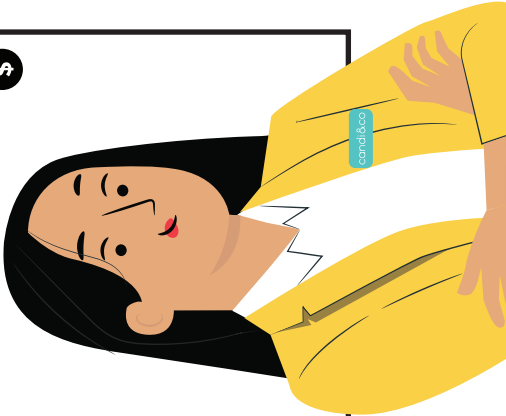


Worksheet 4.3 Business Model Canvas

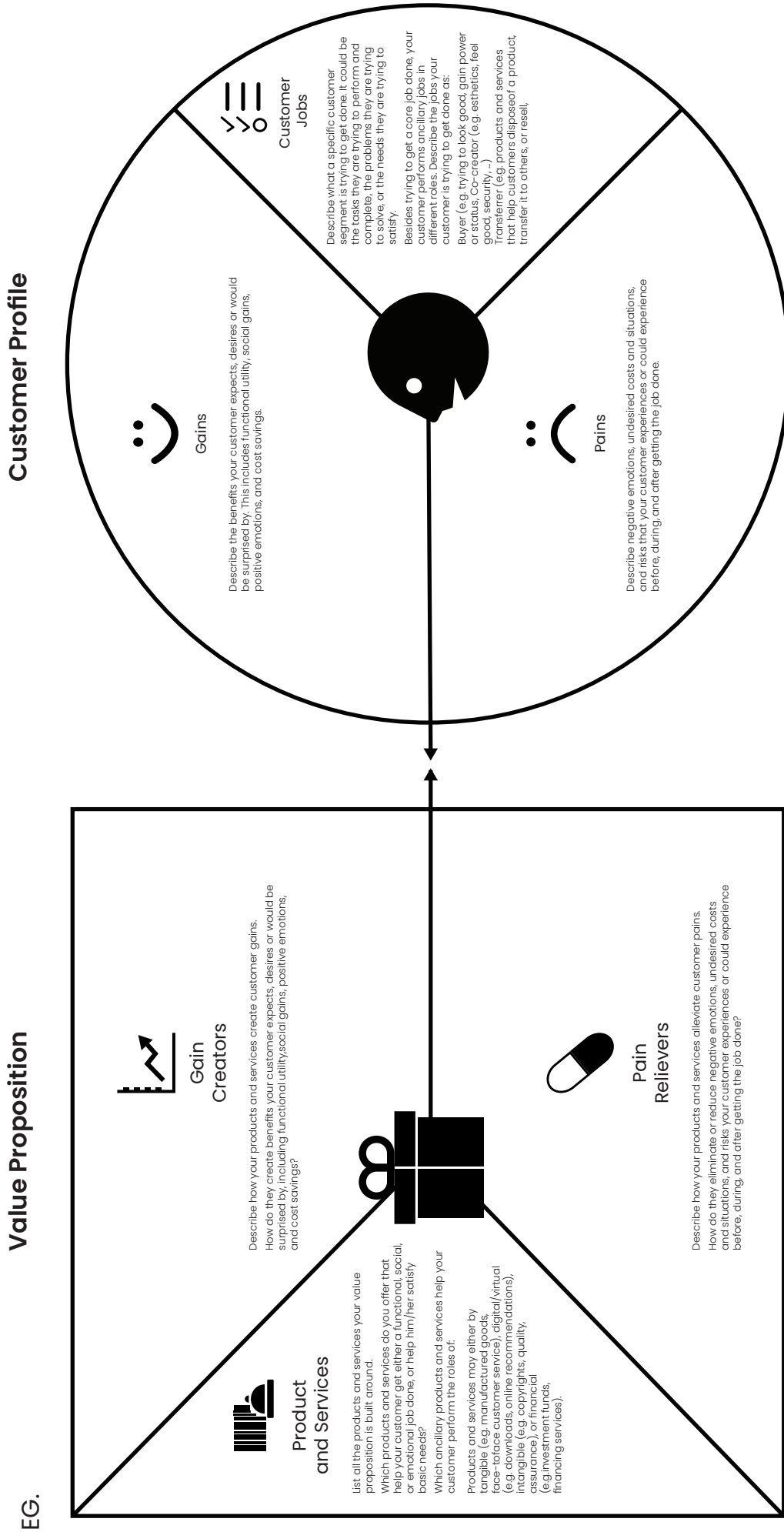
KEY PARTNERS  Who are our Key Partners? Who are our Key Suppliers? Which Key Resources are we acquiring from partners? Which Key Activities do partners perform?	KEY ACTIVITIES  What Key Activities do our Value Propositions require? Our Distribution Channels? Customer Relationships? Revenue streams?	VALUE PROPOSITIONS  What value do we deliver to the customer? Which one of our customer's problems are we helping to solve? What bundles of products and services are we offering to each Customer Segment? Which customer needs are we satisfying?	CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS What type of relationship does each of our Customer Segments expect us to establish and maintain with them? Which ones have we established? How are they integrated with the rest of our business model? How costly are they? CHANNELS  Through which Channels do our Customer Segments want to be reached? How are we reaching them now? How are our Channels integrated? Which ones work best? Which ones are most cost-efficient? How are we integrating them with customer routines?	CUSTOMER SEGMENTS  For whom are we creating value? Who are our most important customers?
COST STRUCTURE  What are the most important costs inherent in our business model? Which Key Resources are most expensive? Which Key Activities are most expensive?			REVENUE STREAMS  For what value are our customers really willing to pay? For what do they currently pay? How are they currently paying? How would they prefer to pay? How much does each Revenue Stream contribute to overall revenues?	

Worksheet 4.3 Complete the Business Model Canvas

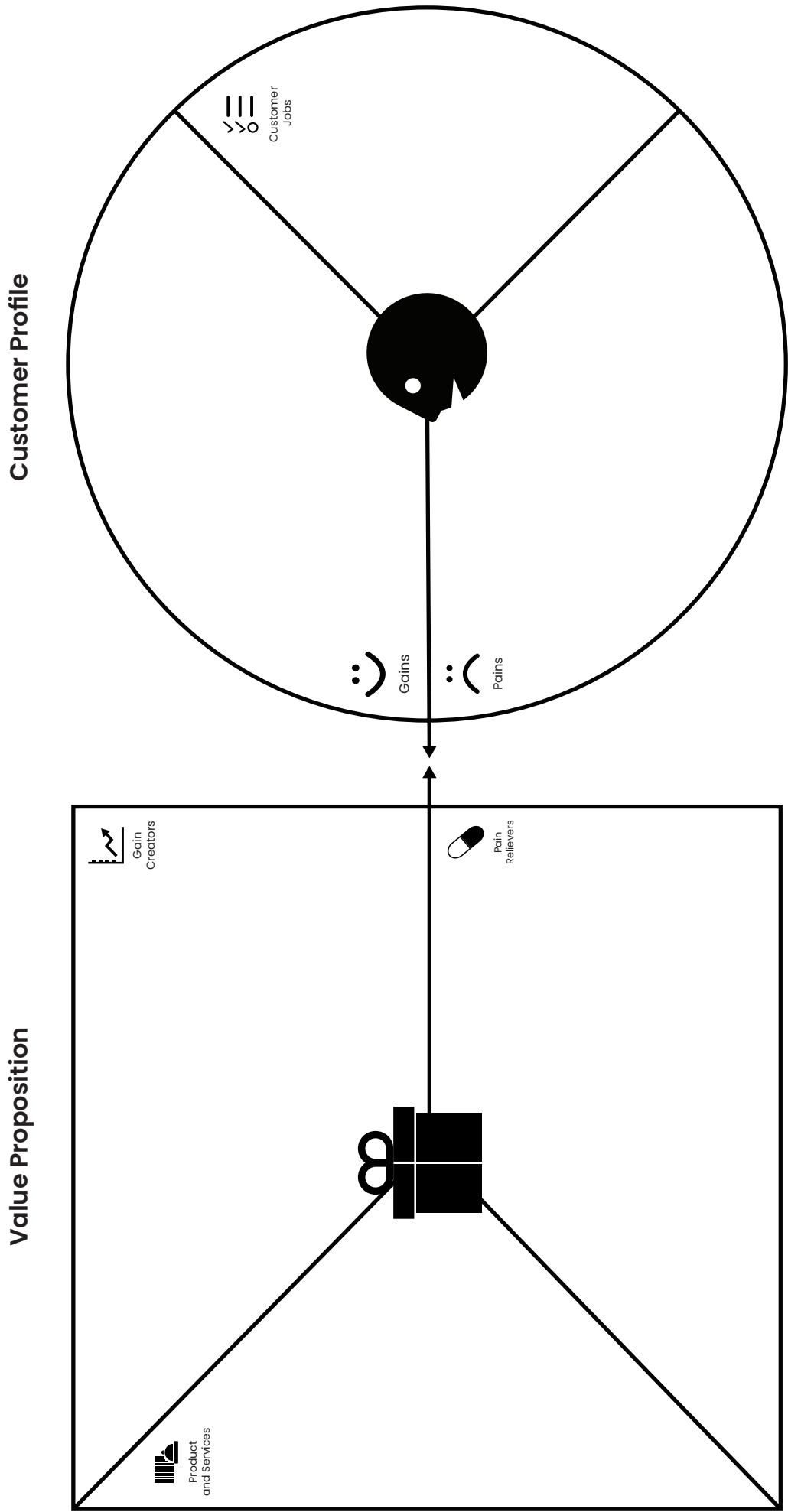
KEY PARTNERS 	KEY ACTIVITIES 	VALUE PROPOSITIONS 	CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS 		CUSTOMER SEGMENTS 
			KEY RESOURCES 	CHANNELS 	
COST STRUCTURE			REVENUE STREAMS 		



Worksheet 4.4 Value Proposition Canvas



Worksheet 4.4 Complete Value Proposition Canvas



Value Proposition

Product and Services

[illegible]

Gain Creators

[illegible]

Pain Relievers

[illegible]

Customer Profile

Gains

[illegible]

Customer Jobs

[illegible]

Pains

[illegible]

Worksheet Five:

The Entrepreneurial Profile

Worksheet 5

Analyse Candi & Co's entrepreneurial capabilities, qualities, and style. Complete the tree map below.

Remember: capabilities (the power or ability to do something), qualities (a distinctive characteristic possessed by someone), and style (a leader's characteristic behaviours when directing and motivating people).

Capabilities	Qualities	Style





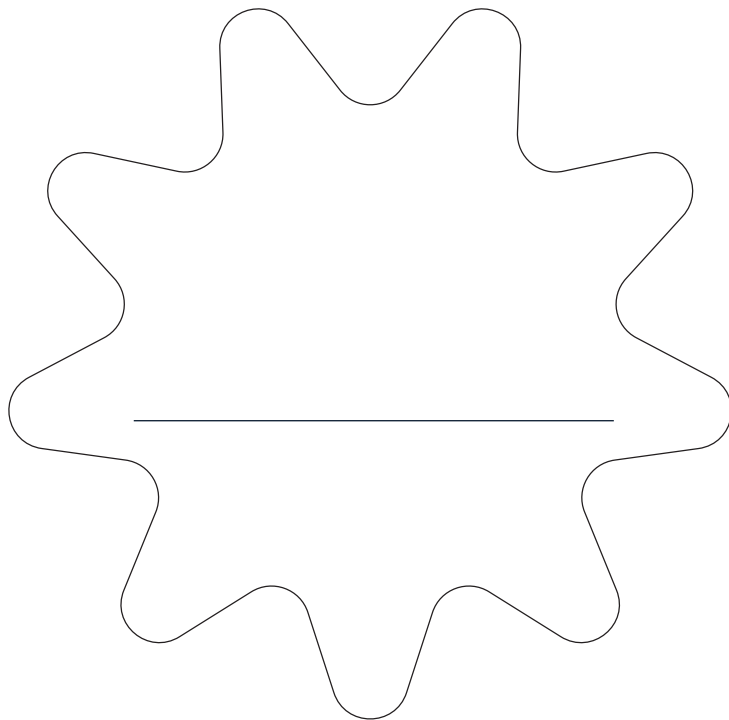
Worksheet Six:

The Entrepreneur's Facts

Worksheet 6

Write down interesting facts that you have learnt about Candice.

Find the word that best describes Candice



Source and write a note worthy quote by Candice that resonates the most.

Candice Thurston Informed Entrepreneurship Workbook



Worksheet Seven:

Entrepreneurial Lessons

Worksheet 7

Reflect on the lessons learned from Candice’s entrepreneurial journey. List and explain the entrepreneurial lessons you have learned or the ones that resonate the most with you.

- 1. _____

- 2. _____

- 3. _____

- 4. _____

- 5. _____

- 6. _____

Worksheet Eight:

Life Lessons

Worksheet 8

Reflect on the broader life lessons learned from Candice's journey. List and reason about the life lessons by categorising them as things you have learned, things you will walk away with, new things you didn't know about, and those that you will act on.

I learnt that... _____

I learnt that... _____

I take away... _____

I take away... _____

I take away... _____

I did not know that... _____

I will Implement... _____



Worksheet Nine:

Take Action



Worksheet Ten:

Interview an Entrepreneur

Worksheet 10

Identify, contact, and interview the entrepreneur; reflect on the entrepreneur engagement experience; and share lessons, recommendations, and feedback.

Worksheet 10.1

In this section, your task is to interview a entrepreneur in your neighbourhood and explore their understanding of entrepreneurship. Through this interview, you will gain insights into the challenges and opportunities that come with starting and running a business.

Step 1:

Identify an entrepreneur in your neighbourhood whom you would like to interview. You can use various resources such as social media, local business directories, or word of mouth to find them.

Step 2:

Contact the entrepreneur and request an interview. You can do this via email, phone call, or in-person visit. Explain the purpose of the interview, the time required, and the expected outcomes.

Step 3:

Prepare a set of questions for the interview. This will help you to focus the conversation and ensure that you cover all the essential aspects of entrepreneurship. Some potential questions might include:

- What inspired you to start your business?
- What are some of the biggest challenges you faced when starting your business?
- How did you overcome these challenges?
- What has been your most successful business venture so far, and why?
- What advice would you give to someone who wants to start their own business?

Step 4:

Conduct the interview. This can be done in-person, over the phone, or via video conferencing. Make sure to record the conversation with the entrepreneur's permission.

Step 5:

Analyze the data collected during the interview. This can be done by reviewing the recording, taking notes, and summarizing the key findings.

Step 6:

Reflect on the insights gained from the interview. This can be done individually or as a group. Consider the challenges and opportunities faced by entrepreneurs and how they impact the local economy.

Step 7:

Write a report summarizing the interview and your reflections. This can be done in the form of a written essay, a presentation, or a video. Make sure to include key takeaways from the interview and any recommendations for aspiring entrepreneurs.

Notes

Step 1: The Entrepreneur

[illegible]

Step 2: The Engagement

[illegible]

Step 3: The Questions

[illegible]

Notes

Step 4: Salient Facts

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Step 5: Key Findings

[illegible]

Step 6: The Reflection

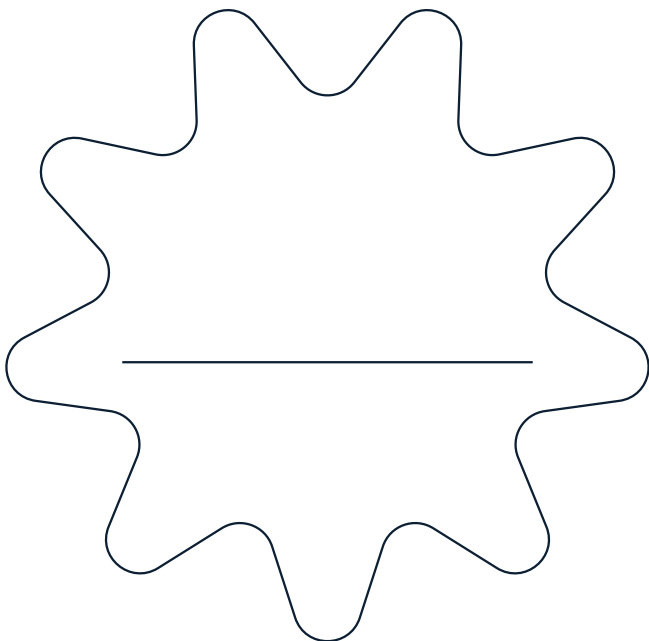
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Notes

Step 7: The Report (Presentation, Podcast, Blog, Newspaper Article...)

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One word that describes the entrepreneur



Worksheet 10.2

Make use of the Entrepreneurship Journey (Worksheet 0) and the Operations Model (Worksheet 4.1) when interviewing the entrepreneur, this will assist in you in the interview process.

Remember:

- The search for the big idea
- The unique opportunity and exploited it
- Challenges faced
- The Wins
- The Lessons

Operations Model (use. Worksheet 4.2) as a guide as well. A framework has been provided for you (page 33).

Remember:

- Inputs
- Production and Transformation
- Output
- Customer Experience

Staffing:

- How many employees are employed by the entrepreneur?
- What roles do they fill?
- What training is offered or should be offered?
- How is performance managed?

Inventory:

- What inventory is managed, and how is it managed?
- How is the supply chain managed, and how are the supply chain relationships managed?
- What tools or systems will you use to track inventory?

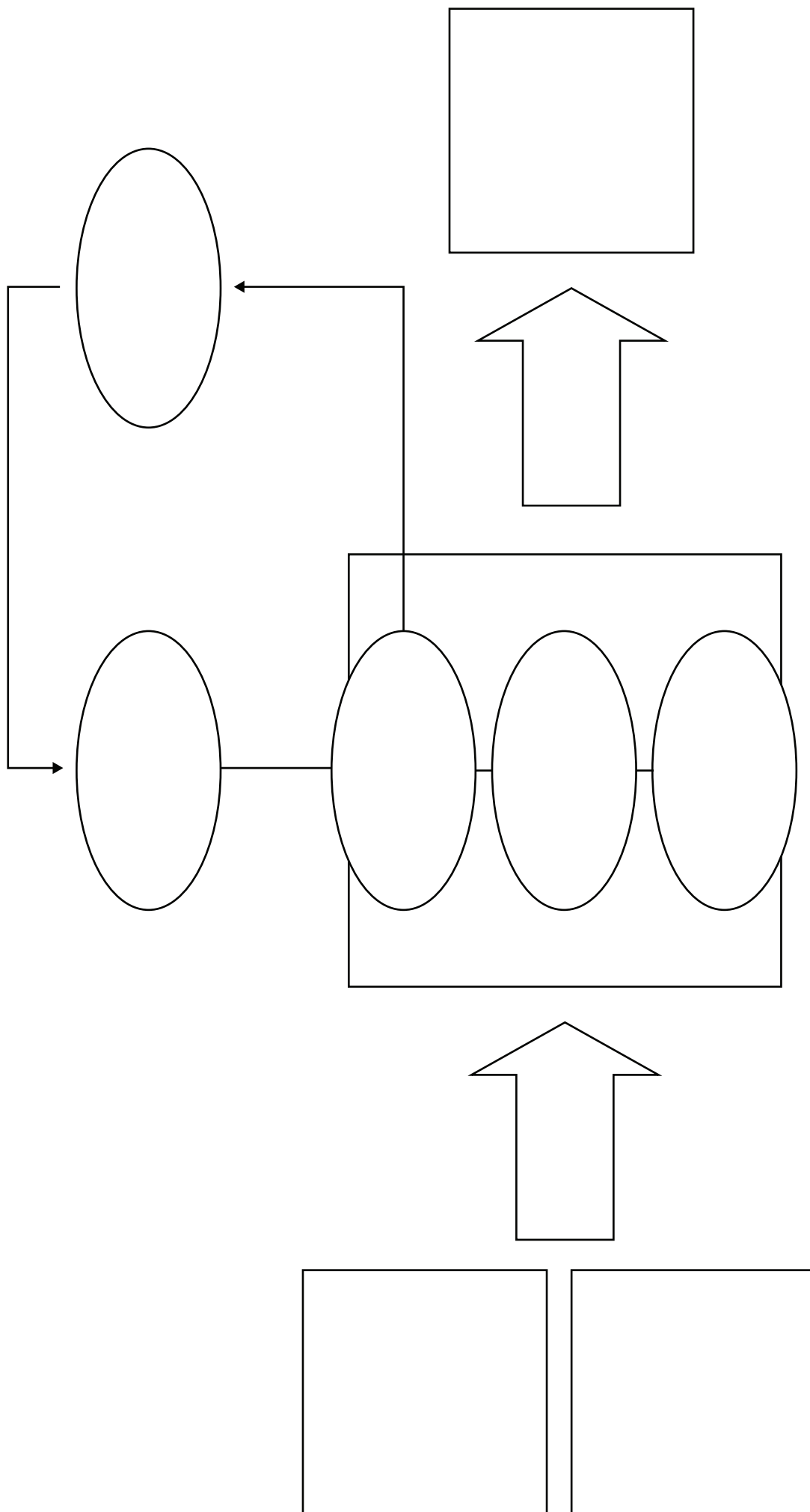
Customer Service:

- What is the customer service philosophy?
- How does the entrepreneur ensure that customers are satisfied?
- How is customer satisfaction measured?
- How does he or his business respond to feedback?

Review the operations plan of the entrepreneur:

- Identify where the current operational plan falls short. What shortfalls did you identify?
- Make recommendations to close the identified gaps. What recommendations did you make?
- How open to feedback was the entrepreneur? How did you determine this?

Worksheet 10.2 Complete the Operation Process



Notes

Gaps

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Recommendations

[illegible]

Feedback

[illegible]

The Author



Dr Steven Zwane (BSc Computer Science – University of Zululand, SA; Master of Business Administration & Doctor of Business Administration – Durham University, UK)

Steven Zwane is a highly accomplished entrepreneur and dedicated educator, renowned for his influential role in shaping youth leadership and entrepreneurship in South Africa. As the visionary founder of Youth Leadership and Entrepreneurship Development, Steven has empowered over 20,000 young minds, particularly focusing on Grade 11 students, imparting crucial entrepreneurship skills.

With a wealth of experience spanning two decades, Steven holds a prominent position as an entrepreneurship, operations, and strategy lecturer at the Gordon Institute of Business Science. Recently earning his Doctor of Business Administration from Durham University Business School (UK), he solidifies his commitment to entrepreneurship education.

Steven's research is centered on youth entrepreneurship, education frameworks, and role modeling, particularly for the underprivileged. His doctoral research, "Determining the Influence of Entrepreneurial Intervention on Entrepreneurial Intentions of Youth in South Africa," showcases his dedication to enhancing entrepreneurship training among in-school youth.

Beyond academia, Steven is a devoted volunteer facilitator at YLED for over 20 years, actively contributing to program design and execution. His hands-on involvement adds authenticity to his advocacy for embedding entrepreneurship education in the South African curriculum from an early age.

Through his impactful Entrepreneurship Workbook series, Steven demonstrates practical methods to extend entrepreneurship lessons to the youth. The workbook features entrepreneurs who generously shared their real-world experiences, reinforcing Steven's commitment to making entrepreneurship education an integral part of South Africa's educational framework. His vision is clear: to empower the next generation with the knowledge and mindset for economic independence and job creation.

Dr. Steven Zwane, holding a BSc in Computer Science from the University of Zululand, South Africa, is a distinguished Entrepreneurship Advocate and Educator. With an illustrious academic journey, Steven has earned both a Master of Business Administration and a Doctor of Business Administration from Durham University, UK.



PAPO Communications is a cutting edge management and strategy solutions consulting Business with special focus on human capital development, Business Strategy, Change Management, Technological Solutions and Youth Development services that are targeted at organisations of all sizes.

We use flexible networked models to scale up for the large and complex projects but also to add value on smaller projects as well.

This is reminiscent of our dedication to partnering with clients to deliver measurable and sustainable results with high impact.

We have experience working with local and global organisations in a range of industries. The company is led by Steven Zwane, a 2006/7 Nelson Mandela Scholar, experienced Operations & Technology and Management Consultant and a champion of youth leadership and entrepreneurship development in South Africa – having started and executed a Life Skills and Mentorship Programme for global IT and management consulting firm as well as two of the top four banks in South Africa, he established the youth development focused NGO – YLED.

Papo Communications Aims to provide a wide range of Management Consulting, Strategy Development, Strategy Cascade, Youth Development, Electronic Communication and Technology access services to the community, public and private sector.

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